

Akka vs. Salesforce Agentforce

A comparison for teams building agentic AI

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Agentforce is a SaaS application-layer agent bound to the Salesforce platform and data model — excellent inside Salesforce, but not a general-purpose agentic runtime, and not a delivered system. It is priced by consumption (per-action Flex Credits or per-conversation), its agents are grounded in Salesforce CRM metadata and Data Cloud, and its governance is scoped to the Salesforce ecosystem through the Einstein Trust Layer — not to the EU AI Act broadly. Reaching a governed, cross-system agentic application means integrating Agentforce yourself or contracting a systems-integration engagement, with no single vendor accountable for the outcome. Akka is a full-stack agentic systems platform that runs any cross-system agentic workload, with EU AI Act enforcement embedded in the runtime — and Akka Specify can deliver and operate the finished governed system for you as a guaranteed outcome, for one fixed price.

99.9999%

AKKA AVAILABILITY SLA

Weeks

AKKA SPECIFY DELIVERY

Fixed

ONE ALL-IN PRICE

90%

LESS INFRASTRUCTURE

DIMENSION	SALESFORCE AGENTFORCE	AKKA
What it is	A SaaS application-layer agent platform inside the Salesforce ecosystem	A full-stack agentic systems platform
How you reach production	Self-integrate Agentforce into a broader system, or contract a systems-integration engagement	Build with spec-driven development, or Akka Specify delivers and runs it
Commercial model	Consumption — Flex Credits (20 credits / \$0.10 per action) or \$2 per conversation, plus integration labor	One fixed price — platform, infrastructure, tokens, training, delivery, and operations
Outcome guarantee	Effort only; the integration outcome is not guaranteed	The delivered outcome is guaranteed
Scope	Agents grounded in Salesforce CRM metadata and Data Cloud; external systems reached via Flow / API callouts	General-purpose runtime for any agentic workload, across any system
Platform dependency	Add-on to Salesforce licenses; Data Cloud is a technical prerequisite	None — Akka cloud, any hyperscaler VPC, your Kubernetes, on-prem, sovereign cloud
Availability SLA	No contractual uptime SLA; standard MSA "commercially reasonable efforts," ~99.9% in practice	99.9999% — entire platform, backed by indemnities
RTO / RPO	Not published for the agent layer	Sub-1-minute RTO; zero-byte RPO; active-active HA/DR
Cost model	Consumption — Flex Credits (20 credits / \$0.10 per action) or \$2 per conversation	Shared compute; up to 90% lower infrastructure for the same workload
Governance / EU AI Act	Einstein Trust Layer — toxicity/bias detection, masking, audit log, scoped to Salesforce	Aspect-woven runtime enforcement + full pre-production governance (186 regulations / 877 controls)
Build audience	Salesforce admins / developers in Agentforce Builder & Agent Script	Two independent lifecycles — build (PM/dev/ML/domain) and govern (risk/security/compliance)
Improves after go-live	Not provided	Continuous evaluation, reinforcement learning, and distillation — up to 80% lower token cost over time

Certifications	Salesforce trust / compliance program	19 standards (SOC 2 II + public SOC 3, ISO 27001/42001, HIPAA, PCI DSS, GDPR, NIS2, DORA, EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF)
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1. A SaaS Application-Layer Agent vs. a General-Purpose Runtime

Agentforce is an application-layer agent platform built into Salesforce. Its agents are authored in Agentforce Builder, compiled by Agent Script into Salesforce metadata, and executed by the Atlas Reasoning Engine — grounded in Salesforce CRM objects and Data Cloud. That is what makes it excellent inside Salesforce, and what bounds it there. Salesforce describes a four-layer stack: a Data layer (Data Cloud), an Application layer (CRM objects and business logic), an AI/Model layer (Einstein models, the Atlas Reasoning Engine, and third-party LLMs), and an Agent layer (salesforce.com). Agentforce reaches non-Salesforce systems through Flow and API callouts, but orchestration, reasoning, and state live inside Salesforce — "the goal is to make data available in Salesforce" (salesforceben.com). Akka is not an application; it is the runtime an agentic system runs on — native agents, durable in-memory state, real-time streaming, an API layer, orchestration, observability, and governance as one platform, for any workload, independent of any single SaaS data model.

Capability	Agentforce	Akka
Agents inside the Salesforce ecosystem	Native, deeply integrated	Runs alongside via APIs
General-purpose runtime for any agentic workload	Bounded to Salesforce; external systems via Flow/API	Built in — any system
State / reasoning location	Inside Salesforce (CRM metadata, Data Cloud)	Durable in-memory, vendor-neutral, 4ms / sub-10ms
Platform prerequisite	Salesforce license + Data Cloud	None
Deploy on your own infrastructure	No — Salesforce-hosted SaaS	Akka cloud, hyperscaler VPC, Kubernetes, on-prem, sovereign

2. Two Ways to Production: Integrate It Yourself, or Have It Delivered

Agentforce agents are built and reasoned about inside Salesforce; reaching a governed, cross-system production application means integrating Agentforce with the rest of your systems yourself, or contracting a systems-integration engagement — in either case, you own the assembly and the outcome. Akka offers a second path: **Akka Specify** takes your specifications and delivers and operates the whole governed system for you as a guaranteed outcome — in weeks, for one fixed price.

	With Salesforce Agentforce	With Akka Specify
Model	Self-integrate Agentforce into a broader system, or a systems-integration engagement	You provide the specifications
Who does the work	Your engineers, or a systems integrator	Akka generates, governs, delivers, and runs the system
Timeline	Months, by construction	Weeks, not quarters
Billing	Consumption metering, plus integration labor	One fixed price
Afterward	You own the integrated system and its operations	Kept up, safe, and improving — operated by Akka
Guarantee	Effort is guaranteed; the outcome is not	The delivered outcome is guaranteed

Agentforce's own architecture stops at the boundary of Salesforce: it reaches non-Salesforce systems through Flow and API callouts, and assembling those into one governed, cross-system agentic application — a collection of Salesforce services the customer must integrate — is the customer's responsibility, whether performed in-house or through a systems-integration engagement billed for effort, with no single vendor accountable for the outcome. Akka Specify inverts that: you provide a handful of plain-language specifications, and Akka generates, tests, governs, deploys, and runs the system — then keeps it available, safe, and improving under one agreement, as one accountable owner.

3. Availability and Disaster Recovery

Agentforce does not publish a contractual availability SLA for the agent layer. Salesforce's standard Master Subscription Agreement commits to "**commercially reasonable efforts**" to make services available 24/7, not a numeric uptime guarantee; Salesforce reports roughly 99.9% uptime in practice but does not contractually commit to it, and the standard agreement provides no automatic service credits for downtime (scnsoft.com, redresscompliance.com).

Metric	Agentforce	Akka
Contractual availability SLA	None published; "commercially reasonable efforts"	99.9999%
Uptime in practice	~99.9% reported, not contractually committed	99.9999%, contractual
Service credits	None under standard MSA	Backed by indemnities
RTO / RPO	Not published for the agent layer	Sub-1-minute RTO / zero-byte RPO
SLA scope	—	The entire platform
Who operates it	The customer, or a systems integrator	Akka SREs, 24/7

Akka owns *and operates* the SLA across the entire platform, with active-active HA/DR across regions and 24/7 SRE.

4. Up to 90% Cheaper to Operate — and It Keeps Getting Cheaper

AI systems built with Akka are up to **90% cheaper to operate** than Python-based systems — a function of the infrastructure required for the same agentic transaction volume, not list price. The drivers are actor concurrency (~10 trillion tokens per core per year vs ~2 trillion; ~80% less compute than Python-based frameworks), shared compute, and micro-checkpointing. Manulife reported up to 300% more concurrency and 30–50% faster processing after porting from Python (akka.io/blog/go-slow-to-go-fast).

Agentforce is priced by **consumption**. Under Flex Credits a standard action costs 20 credits — about \$0.10 at roughly \$500 per 100,000 credits; an alternative Conversations model bills \$2 per conversation, and the two cannot coexist in one org (jitendrazaa.com). The meter moves with usage. Akka runs everything on one shared-compute runtime for **one fixed price** — covering platform, infrastructure, tokens, training, delivery, and operations — finance can forecast.

And it keeps getting cheaper after go-live

The delivered outcome compounds. Akka Verify runs continuous evaluation, reinforcement learning on production and synthetic data, and distillation to smaller specialized models — cutting token cost **up to 80%** while raising accuracy over time. Agentforce's consumption pricing does not fall this way: every action or conversation continues to meter at the published Flex Credit or Conversation rate. With Akka Specify, that tuning is part of the operated outcome, not a project the customer runs later.

5. Governance: Salesforce-Scoped vs. the EU AI Act Broadly

Agentforce governs through the Einstein Trust Layer: toxicity and bias detection, prompt/response masking, a zero-retention LLM gateway, and an audit trail logged to Data Cloud (salesforce.com/eu). It is real, and it is scoped to the Salesforce ecosystem and the data flowing through it. It is not a broad EU AI Act conformance program: it does not perform pre-deployment high-risk classification, gate a deployment before it ships, capture multi-persona regulatory sign-offs, or produce a sealed, portable audit artifact for systems outside Salesforce.

The penalties are enforceable now

Violation	Maximum Fine
Prohibited AI practices (Art. 5)	EUR 35M or 7% global turnover
High-risk obligations (Art. 9-15)	EUR 15M or 3% global turnover

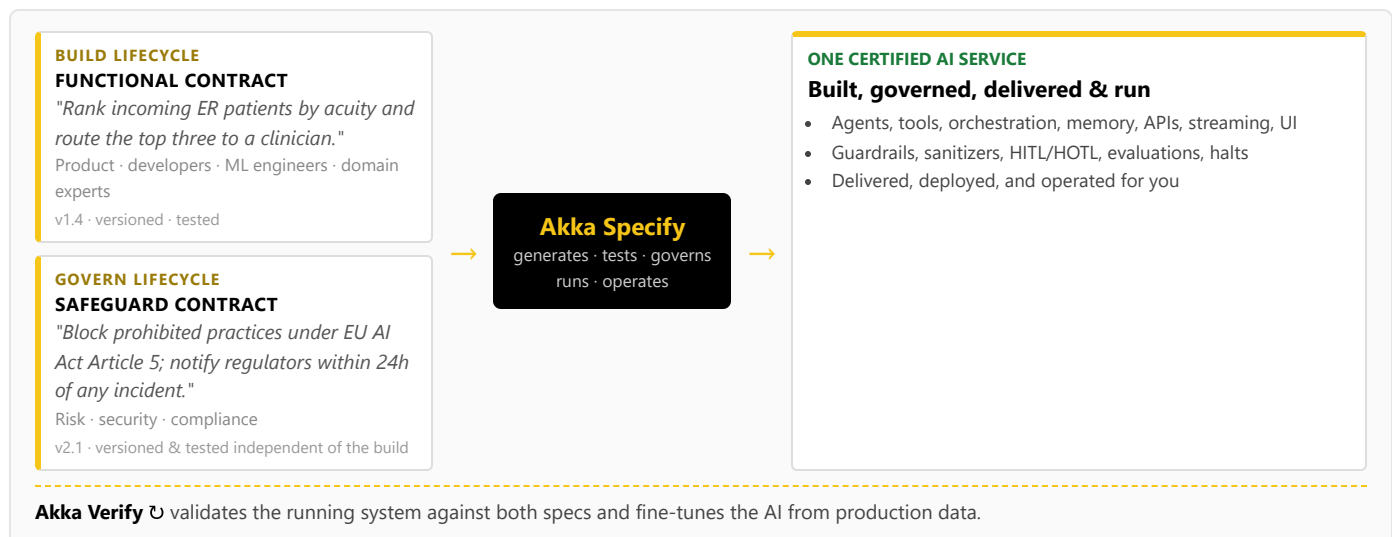
High-risk AI carries a 10-year logging-retention obligation (Art. 72); the penalties apply to the whole AI system, not only the part inside Salesforce.

How Akka governs

At the runtime: inline guardrails, policies, LLMs-as-a-judge, and sanitizers; hash-chained immutable evidence; HITL/HOTL control; atomic PII scrub-with-explain; pre-deployment classification against **186 regulations and 877 controls** (288 carrying a financial penalty); multi-persona sign-offs; a sealed Governance Posture Package; and Akka Verify proving conformance from the running system — for any workload, not only the part inside a single SaaS application.

6. One Certified System — Built, Governed, Delivered, and Run

Building on Agentforce means Salesforce admins and developers authoring agents in Agentforce Builder and Agent Script; there is no co-equal, independently versioned governance lifecycle owned by risk and compliance, and no delivery model beneath it. Akka runs two independent lifecycles on one platform via **Akka Specify**:



Akka generates, tests, governs, **runs, and operates** one certified AI service that satisfies both specifications — agents, tools, orchestration, memory, APIs, streaming, and UI, together with guardrails, sanitizers, HITL/HOTL gates, evaluations, and interaction, evidence, and causal logging. The build lifecycle and the governance lifecycle are versioned and tested independently, by different audiences — and, through

Akka Specify, the whole certified system is delivered and operated as a guaranteed outcome. Agentforce has no equivalent for either the independent governance lifecycle or the delivery model.

7. Real-Time Streaming at Petabyte Scale

Akka's streaming is built into the runtime — continuous, backpressured, petabyte-scale, in-memory, with no external broker — powering both agent feedback loops and high-throughput data processing. It is the engine behind Tubi's real-time hyper-personalization at 5 billion tokens per second. Agentforce, as a SaaS application-layer product, has no comparable general-purpose streaming runtime; data movement runs through Salesforce platform services and Data Cloud, inside the Salesforce ecosystem.

8. For the Buyer: Product Maturity, Lock-In, and Accountability

Salesforce the company is durable; the question is the **Agentforce product**. Agentforce 360 reached general availability on February 23, 2026, in the Spring '26 release, introducing Agentforce Builder, Agent Script, Agentforce Voice, and Intelligent Context (ciodive.com). The product is young and moving fast — the authoring model and the pricing model are both recent. Standardizing on it means accepting that maturity curve and the platform lock-in below.

Buyer concern	Agentforce	Akka
Product maturity	Agentforce 360 GA Feb 2026; new authoring model (Agent Script) and pricing model recently introduced	18 years, 100,000+ production deployments, 52 banks
Platform lock-in	Add-on to Salesforce licenses; Data Cloud a technical prerequisite; agents bound to the Salesforce data model	No platform dependency; portable specs; deploy anywhere incl. sovereign cloud
Workload scope	Excellent inside Salesforce; external systems via Flow/API	Any agentic workload across any system
Availability accountability	No contractual SLA; standard MSA "commercially reasonable efforts"	One platform, one SLA, 24/7 SRE — Akka owns the running system
Delivery & outcome	Self-integrate, or a systems-integration engagement; effort is guaranteed, the outcome is not	Akka Specify delivers and operates the system for one fixed price; the outcome is guaranteed
Certifications & audits	Salesforce trust / compliance program	19 standards — SOC 2 II + public SOC 3, ISO 27001/42001, HIPAA, PCI DSS, GDPR, NIS2, DORA, EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF — plus annual pen tests, SBOMs, 40+ policies (trust.akka.io)
Budget predictability	Consumption metering that scales with usage, plus integration labor	One fixed price finance can forecast

The decision is scope and accountability: Agentforce is the right agent for work that lives inside Salesforce; Akka is the runtime for agentic systems that must span systems, carry a contractual SLA, govern to the EU AI Act broadly, and run on infrastructure you choose — and, through Akka Specify, Akka will deliver and operate the finished system for you.

Customers Running Agentic and Real-Time Systems on Akka

Manulife 2,000 developers across 100 projects on one governed platform	Tubi 5B tok/s real-time hyper-personalization engine	Swiggy 71ms order-assignment AI, ~50% latency reduction	John Deere 1,000+ tractor sensors turned into real-time insight	Verizon 750% order-processing capacity gain; 6s → 2.4s response
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Common Questions

We don't have a team to integrate this — what are our options?

Two. Build the general-purpose runtime on Akka with spec-driven development, or have Akka Specify deliver and operate the whole governed system for you. You provide plain-language specifications; Akka generates, governs, delivers, and runs the system as a guaranteed outcome, for one fixed price. With Agentforce, reaching a governed system that spans Salesforce and the rest of your estate is self-integration or a systems-integration engagement — billed for effort, with no single vendor accountable for the outcome.

Doesn't Agentforce already handle the EU AI Act with the Einstein Trust Layer?

The Einstein Trust Layer provides real safeguards — toxicity and bias detection, masking, a zero-retention gateway, and an audit trail — scoped to the Salesforce ecosystem. The EU AI Act applies to the entire AI system and expects pre-deployment high-risk classification, deployment gating, multi-persona sign-offs, immutable records, and a portable conformance artifact. Akka embeds these inline and covers pre-deployment governance against 186 regulations and 877 controls.

How is Akka Specify different from a systems-integration engagement to assemble Agentforce into a broader system?

A systems-integration engagement sells effort — time-and-materials work to wire Agentforce, Data Cloud, and the rest of your systems together — and hands back an assembled system you own and operate; the outcome is not guaranteed, and no single vendor is accountable for it end to end. Akka Specify sells the outcome: a governed system delivered in weeks for one fixed price, then kept up, safe, and improving by Akka. You own the specifications, not the integration burden.

We already run Salesforce. Why add Akka?

Agentforce is excellent for agents that operate inside Salesforce, grounded in your CRM data. If you are building agentic systems that span multiple systems of record, need a contractual availability SLA, or must govern to the EU AI Act across the whole system, those are runtime concerns Agentforce does not cover. Akka runs alongside Salesforce and provides the general-purpose runtime.

Sources

Agentforce pricing: g2.com/products/salesforce-agentforce/pricing; jitendrazaa.com — Flex Credits ~\$500/100k credits, standard action 20 credits (\$0.10), Conversations \$2/conversation, models cannot coexist in one org (2026)

Agentforce architecture: salesforce.com/agentforce/what-is-a-reasoning-engine/atlas; developer.salesforce.com — Atlas Reasoning Engine (graph-based), Agent Script compiled into Salesforce metadata; four-layer stack (Data Cloud / Application / AI-Model / Agent)

Agentforce scope / lock-in: salesforceben.com/how-does-salesforces-agentforce-work; titandxp.com; redresscompliance.com — add-on to Salesforce licenses, Data Cloud technical prerequisite, external systems via Flow/API

Agentforce 360 GA: ciodive.com; salesforce.com/agentforce/what-is-new — GA Feb 23, 2026 (Spring '26): Agentforce Builder, Agent Script, Agentforce Voice, Intelligent Context

Salesforce SLA: scnsoft.com/blog/salesforce-downtime; redresscompliance.com — standard MSA "commercially reasonable efforts," ~99.9% in practice, no contractual uptime commitment, no automatic credits

Einstein Trust Layer: salesforce.com/eu/artificial-intelligence/trusted-ai; getgenerative.ai; gettectonic.com — toxicity/bias detection, masking, zero-

Is Agentforce cheaper because it's part of our Salesforce contract?

Agentforce is a consumption add-on: Flex Credits at roughly \$0.10 per action (20 credits), or \$2 per conversation, on top of the required Salesforce platform and Data Cloud licenses. The meter scales with usage. Akka's shared-compute runtime is up to 90% cheaper to operate for the same agentic transaction volume, on one fixed price.

Can Agentforce run our agents outside Salesforce?

Agentforce can call external systems through Flow and API callouts, but the reasoning, orchestration, and state live inside Salesforce, and Data Cloud is a technical prerequisite. For agentic workloads whose center of gravity is outside Salesforce — or that must be portable across clouds and on-prem — Akka provides a vendor-neutral runtime with no platform dependency.

retention LLM gateway, audit trail logged to Data Cloud; scoped to the Salesforce ecosystem

Akka performance: akka.io/blog/go-slow-to-go-fast — Manulife up to 300% more concurrency, 30–50% faster; ~10T vs ~2T tokens/core; ~80% less compute than Python

Akka Specify (spec-driven delivery): akka.io / akka.io/llms.txt — you provide the specifications; Akka generates, tests, governs, delivers, and operates the system as a guaranteed outcome; one fixed price covering platform, infrastructure, tokens, training, delivery, and operations; delivered in weeks; continuous improvement via reinforcement learning and distillation (up to 80% lower token cost, higher accuracy)

Akka platform: 99.9999% availability, active-active HA/DR, sub-1 min RTO, zero byte RPO (contractual indemnities); 186 regulations / 877 controls / 288 with a financial penalty; 100,000+ deployments / 18 years; profitable; Dell Technologies Capital

Akka trust center: trust.akka.io — 19 compliance standards; SOC 2 II + public SOC 3; annual pen tests, SBOMs, 40+ policies